

Save Your Couch From Cat Scratching — Action Checklist

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SET UP THE RIGHT SCRATCHING ALTERNATIVE

- ☐ **Choose a stable scratching surface:** Get a floor-to-ceiling cat tree or a post with a base heavier than 20 pounds to eliminate wobbling and make the cat feel safe when scratching.
- ☐ **Select sisal rope as the material:** Pick a scratching post covered in sisal rope, which is the top-performing texture that most cats prefer over carpet or fabric alternatives.
- ☐ **Place the post next to the couch initially:** Position your new scratching post directly beside the couch at the exact height where your cat is currently scratching, such as armrest level.
- ☐ **Use gradual repositioning after 2-3 weeks:** Move the post 6 inches toward your preferred location only after your cat consistently uses it for 2-3 weeks, repeating every 2-3 weeks.

MAKE THE COUCH UNAPPEALING DURING RETRAINING

- ☐ **Cover couch arm areas with plastic mats:** Place plastic floor mats nub-side up or vinyl runners bubble-texture side up on the couch areas your cat targets most frequently.
- ☐ **Apply double-sided tape to scratch zones:** Stick double-sided tape directly to the couch fabric in areas your cat scratches to create an unpleasant sticky sensation under their paws.
- ☐ **Keep all deterrents in place for 3-4 weeks minimum:** Do not remove deterrents early even if scratching appears to stop, because removing them at week one typically causes the behavior to return within days.
- ☐ **Remove deterrents gradually section by section:** Take off one deterrent section at a time, wait a full week, then remove another, and immediately reinstall if scratching behavior resumes.

BRIDGE THE HABIT WITH TEMPORARY NAIL CAPS

- ☐ **Apply soft nail caps as a temporary bridge:** Glue soft nail caps onto your cat's existing claws to make furniture damage physically impossible during the 3-6 week retraining window.
 - ☐ **Reapply nail caps every 4-6 weeks:** Check nail caps monthly and reapply them as they naturally fall off with nail growth and shedding, following the product instructions for proper placement.
 - ☐ **Combine nail caps with other pillars:** Use nail caps alongside the scratching post and deterrents rather than alone, because the three-pillar system works more reliably than any single approach.
 - ☐ **Allow natural scratching behavior during retraining:** Let your cat continue scratching while wearing nail caps since they maintain their natural behavior while protecting your furniture during the transition period.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.